

CAPUCHIN FRANCISCAN FATHERS

SAINT FELIX FRIARY

Huntington, Indiana.

February 12th 1947.

Mrs. Bessie (Gerald) Traynor. Los Angeles Calif'a.

My Dear Niece, Mrs. Traynor:

God bless you and yours. Many thanks for your charitable favor of Jan, 26th duely receiven and noted.

I surely sympathize with you on the passing away of your dear Mother. I wanted to wrote before but it is difficult for me to get through with calls and letters that demand attention.

Thank God, however, that she seems to have been well prepared and willing to respond to God's final call. May she rest with the saints in the peace of which the unbelieving wordl never dreams - awaiting all and each who try....

The same day you wrote, we had a very notable celebration in Detroit, - a solemn Mass of thanks giving as commemorating, my fiftieth year in the Habit of St. Francis. By this time you will no doubt have heard a number of the interesting features. Rt. Msgr. Edw'd and Br. Owen wired of their coming the day before to arrive in Det. at 7:10 p.m. Grace - Mrs B. Brady in the meantime, flew in from San Francisco and met them at the depot - all three arriving at the Monastery together about 7:45. To go into details is so out of the question here that I'll simply have to leave that to others.

If I were only one tenth as grateful and appreciative as I ought to be I would hardly be able to do more than wonder and weep for joy at so many and so great favors following one another for 50 years, etc, all leading up to such a solemnity - as to just another decided "landmark" on the way of an individual's pilgrimage to real LIFE with the God of everlasting glory and the unfading love of the chosen servants in Heaven.

How can we ever thank God as we ought for the inestimable gift of the true faith? A on the other hand, how lament the unfortunate lot of the victims of atheism? - "The climax of intellectual and of spiritual insanity, the hopeless conclusion and the desperate refuge of shallow thinking, of edgenerate minds and (fearful to say), damned fools, none other their primary leader than Lucifer himself the prince of diabolical darkness.

Rt. Rev. Msgr. E'd had to get back to St. Paul. So left Tuesday P.M. Grace went to Toronto and will probably meet the Uncle Ed Traynor and Family. Owen came down with me Saturday Feb. 1st but went back next day.